

Friday, 25 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 24° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 18° 13°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 16° 12°	GLASGOW Light rain 15° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Man jailed for throwing bottle at migrant protest.

Del Somerville, 42, pleaded guilty to violent disorder following an overnight protest at Eastney.

UK · NEWS
- 2

'It has broken us as a family,' mother of poison seller victim tells hearing.

Tanya Whitaker broke down before she spoke of how her son Samuel's death had devastated her family.

UK · NEWS
- 3

Police in Scotland arrest 36 in raids on Vietnamese crime gangs linked to human trafficking.

About 300 officers took part in simultaneous early-morning raids at 47 sites across Scotland.

UK · NEWS
- 4

Sex offender bailed to flat near playground.

Victims of Zapher Dogen were living close to the 32-year-old, who admitted multiple offences.

UK · NEWS
- 5

781 migrants arrive in small boats in 2026 record.

A total of 781 migrants arrive on Wednesday, but the yearly total is below the same point in 2025.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 BBC upholds complaints over Victoria Beckham slur on Have I Got News For You.**
Two viewers complained to the BBC over the "gratuitously offensive" comment made during the show.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Singer Michael Kiwanuka reveals he is recovering from a stroke.**
The award-winning musician says he faces a "tough journey ahead" after a "quite severe" brain injury.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Nigella Lawson is 'icing on the cake', TV critics say as she enters Bake Off tent.**
The TV chef joined Paul Hollywood in the tent as the Channel 4 competition returned for a new series.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Dolly Parton's manager accuses her nephew of 'threats and intimidation'.**
Bryan Seaver, who announced Parton's death to the world, is accused of trying to extort her estate.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Will.i.am backs campaign for Sir Tom Jones to return to The Voice.**
Sir Tom Jones, 86, has appeared as an on-off coach on the ITV show since 2012.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

'The lads wanted me to stick one up him' - Wood relives fastest spells.

As England bowler Mark Wood retires from international cricket, he talks through his most famous spells from his Test career.

SPORT · UK

2

The compromises and power struggles that shaped Fury-Joshua.

BBC Sport takes a look at the compromises, power struggles and competing interests behind Anthony Joshua v Tyson Fury.

SPORT · UK

3

Premier League keen to resolve EFL funding stalemate.

The Premier League hopes to reach an agreement with the EFL over its funding model 'as soon as possible'.

SPORT · UK

4

Leicestershire relegated by Warwickshire, subject to points appeal.

Leicestershire are relegated, subject to an appeal against their points deduction, after being bowled out cheaply by title-chasing Warwickshire.

SPORT · UK

5

Is this really the Premier League's 'Bermuda Triangle'?

Do the stats back the social media meme that Bournemouth, Brighton and Brentford form a Premier League 'Bermuda Triangle' where teams lose points?

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that the gentle art of 'skip-counting' can significantly boost children's early mathematical confidence.**
Researchers found that children who regularly practised counting in twos, fives, or tens showed improved number sense and a reduced fear of maths problems. It seems a simple rhyme can go a long way!
- 2 More people are discovering the quiet charm of 'canal boat holidays' for a unique British getaway.**
With their slow pace and scenic routes, these holidays offer a chance to unwind and explore the countryside from a different perspective. It's all about enjoying the journey, not just the destination.
- 3 The delightful trend of 'decorating garden sheds' is turning humble outbuildings into charming retreats.**
From miniature libraries to cosy craft studios, people are transforming their sheds into personalised havens. It just goes to show, a little imagination can turn any space into something special.
- 4 Experts are encouraging us to rediscover the simple pleasure of 'identifying cloud formations'.**
Learning to recognise cumulus, stratus, and cirrus clouds can offer a surprisingly calming and contemplative way to connect with nature. It's a free and fascinating sky-watching hobby!
- 5 A recent survey indicates a growing interest in 'foraging for wild berries and mushrooms' in the British countryside.**
Under expert guidance, more people are safely enjoying the thrill of finding delicious natural produce. Always remember to know exactly what you're picking, though!
- 6 The charming practice of 'leaving painted stones in public places' for others to find is brightening up parks nationwide.**
These colourful little artworks, often with uplifting messages, bring unexpected smiles to passers-by. It's a small gesture that creates a lovely ripple of joy.
- 7 A new report highlights the growing popularity of 'upcycling old furniture' as a sustainable and creative hobby.**
Instead of throwing out dated pieces, people are giving them a new lease of life with a lick of paint or some clever customisation. It's good for the planet and your home's unique style!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOX A LITTLE SHAKE TO HEAR IF THE CONTENTS SOUND 'CRUNCHY ENOUGH' !

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new book, especially if it's a gripping story. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY FANNING THROUGH ALL THE PAGES TO GET THAT 'NEW BOOK SMELL' !

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't had one in years?
Which biscuit holds a special place in your heart for those nostalgic reasons, and what makes it so memorable?
- We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your kitchen without because it's just so useful or brings you joy, don't we?
What's that unsung hero in your kitchen that you absolutely couldn't do without, and why is it so indispensable?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is actually called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A group of pugs is surprisingly known as a 'wrinkle' because of their distinctive faces.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The official residence of the British monarch in London, Buckingham Palace, has 775 rooms.
- A 'floccinaucinihilipilification' is the act of estimating something as worthless.
- The world's smallest fish, *Paedocypris progenetica*, is only 7.9 millimetres long.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The 'richest' bird's nest ever found contained over 300 pieces of gold jewellery.
- Penguins are birds, but they cannot fly; instead, they are excellent swimmers.

On this day

Day 268 of the year, 97 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day or Revolution Day (Mozambique); Bangladeshi Immigration Day (United States); Christian feast day: Abadir and Irajā and Companions (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Aunarius (Aunacharius). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Robert Walden, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1964 — Maria Doyle Kennedy, Irish actress and singer
- 1976 — Santigold, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1992 — Teddy Swims, American singer and songwriter
- 1981 — Lee Norris, American actor
- 1974 — Paul Hurst, English footballer and manager
- 2009 — Leah Jeffries, American actress
- 1997 — Antonia Gentry, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1956 — TAT-1, the first submarine transatlantic telephone cable system, is inaugurated.
- 1969 — The charter establishing the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation is signed.
- 1974 — Dr. Frank Jobe performs first ulnar collateral ligament replacement surgery (better known as Tommy John surgery) on baseball player Tommy John.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1959 — S. W. R. D. Bandaranaike, Prime Minister of Ceylon, is mortally shot by a Buddhist monk, Talduwe Somarama, and dies the next day.
- 1918 — World War I: The end of the Battle of Megiddo, the climax of the British Army's Sinai and Palestine campaign under General Edmund Allenby.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1955 — The Royal Jordanian Air Force is founded.
- 1915 — World War I: The Second Battle of Champagne begins.

- 1983 — Thirty-eight IRA prisoners, armed with six handguns, hijack a prison meals lorry and smash their way out of the Maze Prison.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 269 of the year, 96 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Canadian Martyrs (Catholic Church in Canada); Christian feast days: Cosmas and Damian; Christian feast days: Blessed Crescencia Valls Espí; Christian feast days: John of Meda. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Anne Robinson, English journalist and game show host
- 1960 — Doug Supernaw, American country music singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2020)
- 1962 — Al Pitrelli, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1961 — Cindy Herron, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1972 — Shawn Stockman, American singer
- 1973 — Chris Small, Scottish snooker player and coach
- 1991 — Dan Preston, English footballer
- 1969 — Paul Warhurst, English footballer and manager

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — Air Caribbean Flight 309 crashes in Residencial Las Casas in San Juan, Puerto Rico, killing six.
- 2002 — The overcrowded Senegalese ferry, MV Le Joola, capsizes off the coast of the Gambia killing more than 1,000.
- 2010 — The Philippine Bar exam bombing occurs near the De La Salle University in Taft Avenue, Manila injuring 47 people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — An earthquake strikes the Italian regions of Umbria and the Marche, causing part of the Basilica of St. Francis at Assisi to collapse.
- 2002 — The overcrowded Senegalese ferry, MV Le Joola, capsizes off the coast of the Gambia killing more than 1,000.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar